Muhammad Zulqurnain Ul Haq Qazi

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Employment

Academic Experience

External Research Fellow
Aug 2022 – Present The Ohio State University – Columbus, OH, USA

- Developed technical data collection tools (e.g., surveys, interview guides, observation checklists).
- Established and maintained effective communication with participants, facilitating their involvement in the study.
- Co-authored scholarly manuscripts, contributing to the dissemination of research findings and impact insights.

Teaching Assistant — Education in Democratic Societies
Fall 2025 The Ohio State University – Columbus, OH, USA

Affiliated Lecturer (Honorary Position)
July 2022 – Present Habib University – Karachi, Pakistan

Lecturer
Jan 2019 – June 2022 Habib University – Karachi, Pakistan

- Taught courses: Public Policy; Education Planning; Social Theory; Pakistan & Modern South Asia; Pakistan Institutions & Youth; Rhetoric & Communication.
- Designed courses: Pakistan Institutions & Youth; The Economy of Modern Sindh; Education Planning.
- Supervised an independent study on the political economy of Karachi.
- Co-supervised a thesis on visual impairment and tertiary education — problems, challenges, and current practices in Karachi.

Adjunct Faculty
Aug 2018 – Dec 2018 Habib University – Karachi, Pakistan

- Taught and designed course: Education Planning

Adjunct Faculty
Jan 2018 – May 2018 Institute of Business Management – Karachi, Pakistan

- Taught & Designed Course: Social Advocacy in South Asia

Development Practice Experience

Policy Intern
Apr 2026 – Present Ohio Department of Education and Workforce – Columbus, OH, USA

- Reviewed ReadOhio's Introduction to the Science of Reading and Science of Reading Refresher training curricula for teacher and field-staff professional learning, ensuring alignment with Ohio's science-of-reading mandate and Senate Bill 19's academic-intervention requirements.
- Conducted a GIS-based spatial analysis of attendee geography for the Ohio Literacy Academy, the department's annual statewide literacy convening, to assess regional representation and identify participation gaps.

- Built an interactive dashboard integrating multiple state programs, giving leadership a consolidated view of school-level intervention overlaps for targeted planning.
- Developed a predictive, school-level forecast of incoming Reading Achievement Plans to help the department proactively allocate review capacity and shape policy response.

Monitoring & Evaluation Lead
Jan 2024 – Feb 2025 Genius Foundation – Zambia (Virtual)

- Designed and implemented evaluation tools to assess the progress and performance of a hybrid research program for STEM participants.
- Analyzed data from 100+ participants using statistical methods to measure program effectiveness, leading to actionable insights and a 25% improvement in participant engagement strategies.

Consultant, Strategy & Collaboration (Commissioned)
Jan 2022 – Aug 2022 Oxford University Press – Karachi, Pakistan

- Advised 10+ public universities across Sindh, Pakistan on the adoption of a regional studies course on Sindh as an undergraduate offering in 9 programs.
- Secured institutional support from university departments, Boards of Faculties, Academic Councils, and Syndicates for the curriculum update.

Founding Director (Voluntary)
Jan 2019 – Present Youth Center for Research – Karachi, Pakistan

- Established a global platform for building transnational learning communities for youth empowerment through research, advocacy, and communication.
- Built collaborations with universities and organizations in Zambia, Nigeria, Pakistan, and Indonesia.
- Designed and have annually executed a flagship Annual Research Program (ARP) — a virtual exchange — since 2019, connecting youth and experts, with nearly 100 alumni from around 27 countries.

World Bank's Technical Assistance
Aug 2014 – Dec 2018 Reform Support Unit, Government of Sindh, Pakistan – Karachi, Pakistan

- Led the design of an internal communication system for the Government of Sindh to improve data sharing among 138 districts and 11 departments.
- Monitored and evaluated 120 deliverables across 8 sub-departments; recommendations were approved by the Education Secretary, leading to a 30% improvement in program execution.

Education

Ph.D. Candidate in Education Policy (Fulbright-funded)
Expected June 2027 The Ohio State University – Columbus, OH, USA

Certificate: Leadership, Policy & Communication (Future Leaders Connect Fellowship)
Nov 2019 University of Cambridge – Cambridge, England

Master of Public Administration & Public Policy (Chevening Scholar)
Jan 2019 University of York – York, England

Bachelor of Business Administration
July 2014 Institute of Business Management (IoBM) – Karachi, Pakistan

Areas of Specialization

Public Policy & Policy Analysis; Policy Advocacy & Communication; Internationalization of Higher Education

Areas of Competence

Human Development & Employability Preparedness; Agent-Structure Interactions & Immigration Policy; Youth Empowerment & Transnational Collaborations.

Research Methods

Quantitative and qualitative methods including structural equation modeling, generalized linear modeling, ethnography, narrative inquiry, and comparative case study approaches.

Software & Tools

R, SPSS, MPlus, NVivo, ArcGIS, NetLogo, MS Excel, MS PowerPoint.

Languages

English (Fluent), Urdu (Native), Punjabi (Fluent), Chinese (Basic).

Research

Research Projects

"Whose Dreams Are Futures Made Of?" Co-design project funded by Honda, in collaboration with 99P Lab, Columbus, Ohio, USA. 2025

Field project analyzing the mathematical identity of immigrant students (ages 8–10) in the USA using digital storytelling as a research method, 2023.

Baseline study analyzing the provincial education communication infrastructure. School Education & Literacy Department, Government of Sindh, 2016.

Reforms Implementation Plan, School Education & Literacy Department, Government of Sindh, 2016.

Publications

Hidayat, A., Abdulrahman, T., Qazi, M.Z.U.H., Abdi, K., Yin, C.H., Nurmalia, & Azram, L. (2026). Mathematics, migration, and voices: Digital storytelling as belonging and epistemic resistance for Muslim immigrant girls. Pedagogy, Culture & Society, 1–22. https://doi.org/10.1080/14681366.2026.2686993

Alnakshabandi, A., Hidayat, A., & Qazi, M.Z.U.H. (2026). Governing inequality: A systematic literature review of how law and technology shape justice for the marginalized. Cogent Social Sciences, 12(1), 2644754.

Hidayat, A., Abdulrahman, T., & Qazi, M. Z. U. H. (2025). Exploring digital storytelling in mathematics education: A systematic review of trends, benefits, and implementation challenges. International Journal of Learning Technology, 20(4), 507–527.

Abdulrahman, T. R., Akber, T., Werghemmi, M., Ashraf, I., Azahra, M., PWD, N. P. E. B., & Qazi, M.Z.U.H. (2025). Global trends and challenges in bilingual teacher education: A systematic review across sociocultural context. International Journal of Education and Learning, 7(1), 1–12.

Submitted / Forthcoming

Dermawansyah, D., Hossain, S., **Qazi, M.Z.U.H**., & Fadhil, M.R. (2026). Teacher-mediated AI for speaking and pronunciation in K-12 EFL/ESL classrooms: A systematic review of learning effects. SSRN. https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.7223218 (SSRN Working Paper)

Qazi, M.Z.U.H., & Abdi, K. Pedagogy of humility: Explorative approach to many ways of knowing. In The Bloomsbury Handbook of Critical Muslim Educational Research. Bloomsbury. ***(Forthcoming)***

Islam, M.B., Bodine Al-Sharif, M.A., Chaiban, T., Khakim, M.N.L., & **Qazi, M.Z.U.H**. Navigating the hidden curriculum of advising: Support, silence, and uncertainty among international doctoral students in US universities. In From Numbers to Narratives: Reframing Transitions, Belonging, and Success. Routledge. ***(Chapter accepted, in preparation)***

Crumley-Effinger, M., & **Qazi, M.Z.U.H**. Theory + policy pervasion: Exploring student visa policy impacts through select social science theories. Current Issues in Comparative Education. ***(Manuscript submitted for publication)***

Work in Progress

Qazi, M.Z.U.H., Hidayat, A., & Abdulrahman, T. International STEM graduate students and their post-study transition in the US. Comparative Case Analysis of three graduate students in the U.S. job market.

Capretta, T., & **Qazi, M.Z.U.H**. Digital tools in education: Opportunities, gaps, and policies shaping learning in classrooms. Comparative analysis of mobile phone ban policy in Ohio, USA, and KP, Pakistan.

Qazi, M.Z.U.H. Equity framework for policy analysis of ICT in education policies. (Under review with Cogent Education)

Qazi, M.Z.U.H., & Crumley-Effinger, M. Websites as tools for geopolitical positioning, ISM policy framing, and postsecondary recruitment. Article in progress for a Special Issue of Higher Education, "Politics of International Student Recruitment and Admission in a Hierarchical and Multi-Polar Landscape of Global Higher Education" (abstract submission deadline August 2026).

Qazi, M.Z.U.H., & Panwar, S.A. Navigating access to higher education: A case of volunteer-led intervention for the underprivileged.

Presentations and Conference Activities

Invited Talks

2026 Invited Panelist — "On the move and under pressure: Housing precarity in international students' post-study transitions," panel on "Economic and Infrastructural Pressures Encountered by International Students" (led by Ryan Allen), Research with International Students Speaker Series (virtual) (March).

2024 Invited Keynote Speaker (delivered virtually), Education: Curriculum Design and Quality Assurance track — "Fostering Knowledge Sharing and Innovation Competitiveness for Production-Development," 2024 International Multi-Disciplinary Conference, Zambia Research Development Centre & Genius Education Zambia, Mulungushi International Conference Centre, Lusaka, Zambia (October 18–20).

Conference Presentations

2026 Crumley-Effinger, M., & Qazi, M.Z.U.H. Policy pervasion in theory: Exploring student visa policy impacts vis-à-vis select social science theories. Annual Education Research Association Conference, Los Angeles, USA (March).

2026 Qazi, M.Z.U.H. Pathways under pressure: Migration, employability, and the limits of student agency. Annual Education Research Association Conference, Los Angeles, USA (March).

2026 Tukutah, L.G., & Qazi, M.Z.U.H. An agentic framework for informal digital spaces within STEM. Annual Education Research Association Conference, Los Angeles, USA (March).

2026 Qazi, M.Z.U.H., & Abdi, K. Many ways of knowing: Pedagogy of humility through Islamic thought. Annual Education Research Association Conference, Los Angeles, USA (March).

2025 Qazi, M.Z.U.H., & Ong, K. Sand and the hourglass: Reflections on temporariness. Workshop designed and executed for graduate students, The Ohio State University (November).

2025 Qazi, M.Z.U.H., & Roman, S. Learner agency in AI-mediated learning: A critical realist perspective. AI in Education Conference, University of Florida, FL, USA (November).

2025 Capretta, T., & Qazi, M.Z.U.H. Digital tools in education: Opportunities, gaps, and policies shaping learning in classrooms. Comparative and International Education Society (CIES) Conference, Chicago, IL, USA (March).

2025 Qazi, M.Z.U.H., Tukutah, L.G., & Smith, H. Agentic framework for informal digital spaces within STEM. Comparative and International Education Society (CIES) Conference, Chicago, IL, USA (March).

2025 Qazi, M.Z.U.H. International student mobility and educational preferences for STEM graduate programs. Education & Human Ecology Research Forum, Columbus, OH, USA (February).

2025 Qazi, M.Z.U.H., & Abdi, K. Teaching with humility: Exploring Islamic critical consciousness in STEM education. Education & Human Ecology Research Forum, Columbus, OH, USA (February).

2024 Hidayat, A., Abdi, K., Abdulrahman, T., Qazi, M.Z.U.H., & Yin, C-H. Empowering voices: Digital mathematics storytelling for Muslim immigrant girls. Poster, 46th Annual Meeting of PMENA, Cleveland, OH, USA (November).

2024 Abdi, K., Qazi, M.Z.U.H., Yin, C-H., Hidayat, A., & Abdulrahman, T. Bridging cultures and numbers: Exploring the mathematical identities of transnational youth through digital storytelling in community literacy events. NCTE-NCTM Joint Conference, New Orleans, LA, USA (June).

2024 Hossain, S., Alkhateeb, B., & Qazi, M.Z.U.H. Smart starts: Harnessing TPACK to propel ethical AI usage in early childhood education. 2024 Sherman Center Research Conference (SCRC), UMBC, Baltimore, MD (June, peer-refereed).

2024 Qazi, M.Z.U.H., Hussain, N., & Singh, K. Analyzing ICT policy in education through an equity funnel framework. Roundtable, American Educational Research Association Conference (AERA), Philadelphia, PA (April, peer-refereed).

2024 Qazi, M.Z.U.H., & Ashar, M. Collaborative governance & human-rights-based approach to development planning. Panel discussion, Social Outcomes Conference, Blavatnik School of Government, University of Oxford, UK (September).

2022 Qazi, M.Z.U.H., & Panwar, S. Navigating access to higher education: A case of volunteer-led education intervention for the underprivileged. Conference on Development: Discourses and Critiques, Institute of Business Administration (IBA) (March).

2017 Gender disparity in Sindh, a tale beyond cultural bounds. Applied Economic and Research Center (AERC) International Conference — "Towards Inclusive Governance and Efficient Institutions for Sustainable Development."

Grants & Funding

2025 Comparative & International Education Society Travel Grant – $1,100, to attend the CIES Conference 2025.

2023 American Educational Research Conference Travel Grant – $900, to attend the Adult Education Research Conference 2023.

Awards

2022–2027 Fulbright Scholarship Award to pursue a Ph.D. in the US.

2020 Selection for American Middle Eastern Network for Dialogue at Stanford (AMENDS), Stanford University, USA.

2019 Future Leaders Connect Fellowship by the British Council and the University of Cambridge, for a Certificate in Public Policy, Communications & Leadership.

2017–2018 Chevening Scholarship Award to pursue a Master's degree in the UK.

Service and Involvement

2026–2027 Webmaster, Study Abroad & International Students SIG, Comparative & International Education Society (CIES).

2025–2026 Graduate Student Representative, Study Abroad & International Students SIG, Comparative & International Education Society (CIES).

2024–2025 Program Lead for Professional Development, AI & Education Research Collective — developing a guided course introducing academics and researchers in education to AI.

2024 Communications & Research Officer, Leadership Team, International Studies SIG, American Educational Research Association (AERA).

2024 Proposal Reviewer, Psychology of Mathematics Education – North American (PME-NA) Chapter Conference, Cleveland, OH, USA.

2022–Present President, Buckeye Brighters — Fulbright Scholars' official representative student organization.

2019–Present Chapter Advisor, Alumni Development Program, The Citizens Foundation (Pakistan's largest non-profit organization).